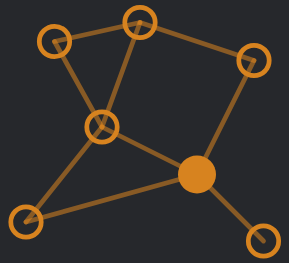
ISAC Yearly Seminar · Shenkar

Who Gets to Submit?

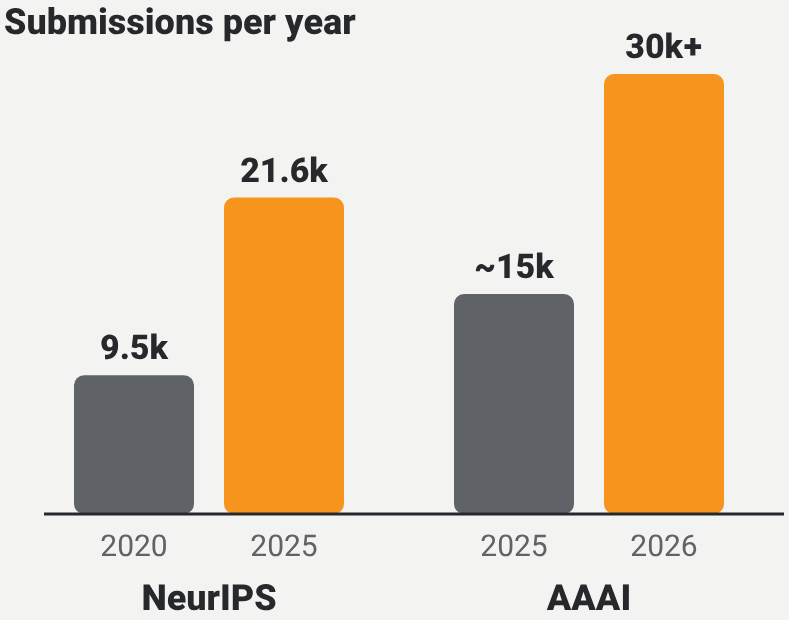
Designing credit systems for peer review



Nimrod Talmon · with Ariel Rosenfeld, Peter Stone and Staša Milojević

Ben-Gurion University of the Negev · November 2026

Writing got cheap; reviewing, much less



1. AI reviews help: at AAAI-26, every paper got one
2. Still, we want human gatekeepers: judgment, taste
3. Overload makes reviews noisier

Venues already ration submissions

Each of these is a crude credit system



Caps

at most N papers



Embargoes

rejected? wait



Review to submit

submit, then review



Fees

pay per paper

Let's design the credit system properly

The goal

Accept as many good papers as possible, and as few weak ones



many good

few weak

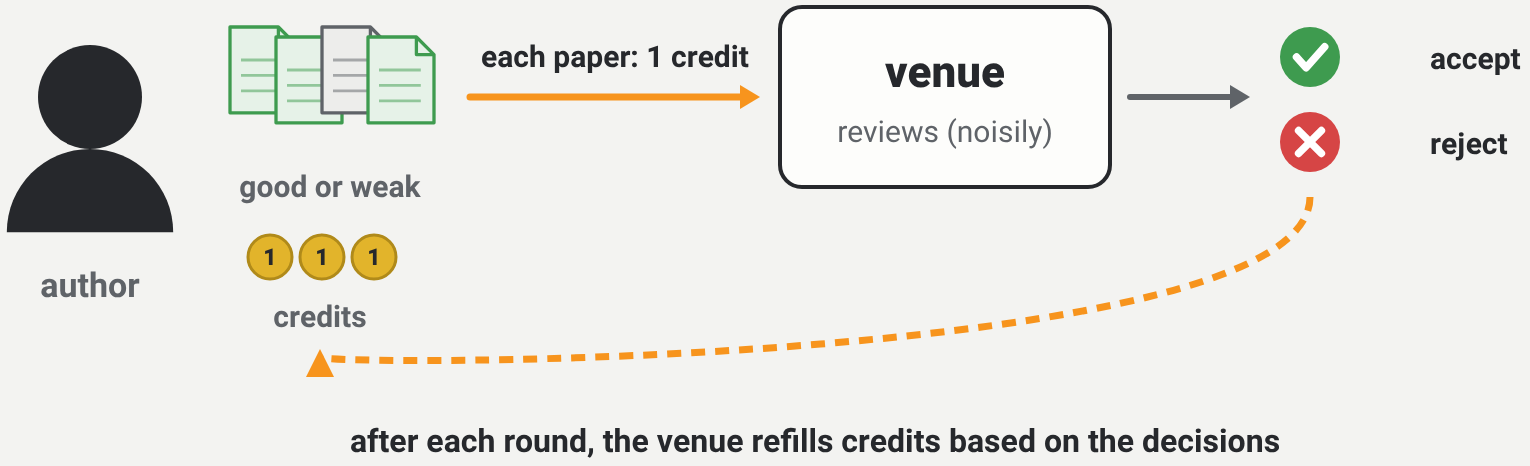
Fair to authors

1. More good papers, more credits
2. Always at least one credit
3. Slow periods are free

The simplest setting

Paper: “Who Gets to Submit?” · with Rosenfeld, Stone and Milojević · NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on AI-Native Academia

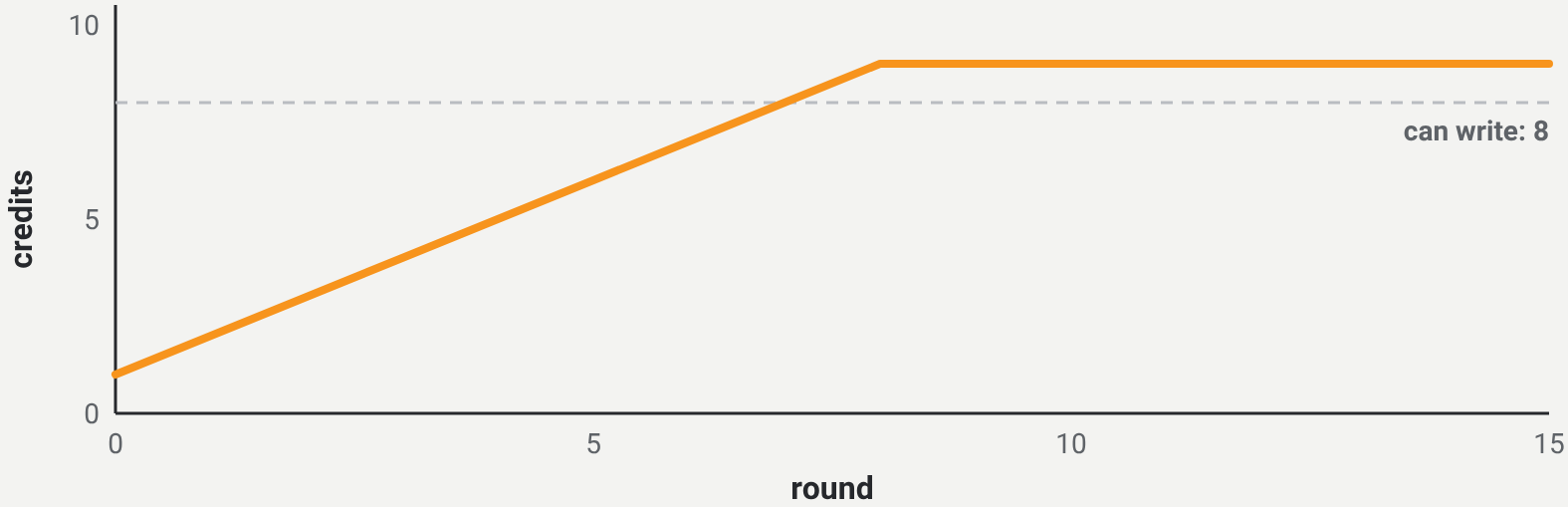
One venue · one author per paper · each paper is good or weak



The perfect-round bonus

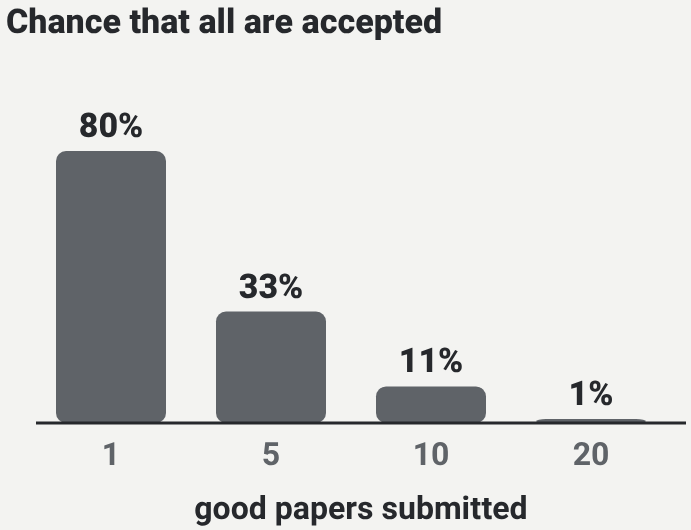
If we assume no noise, then a solution exists

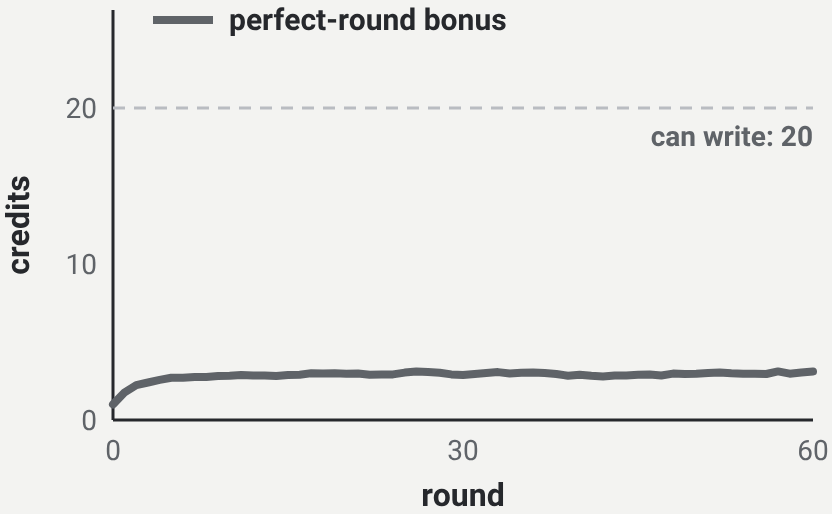
Each accepted paper returns its credit; if all are accepted, then +1 bonus



But with noise, it breaks

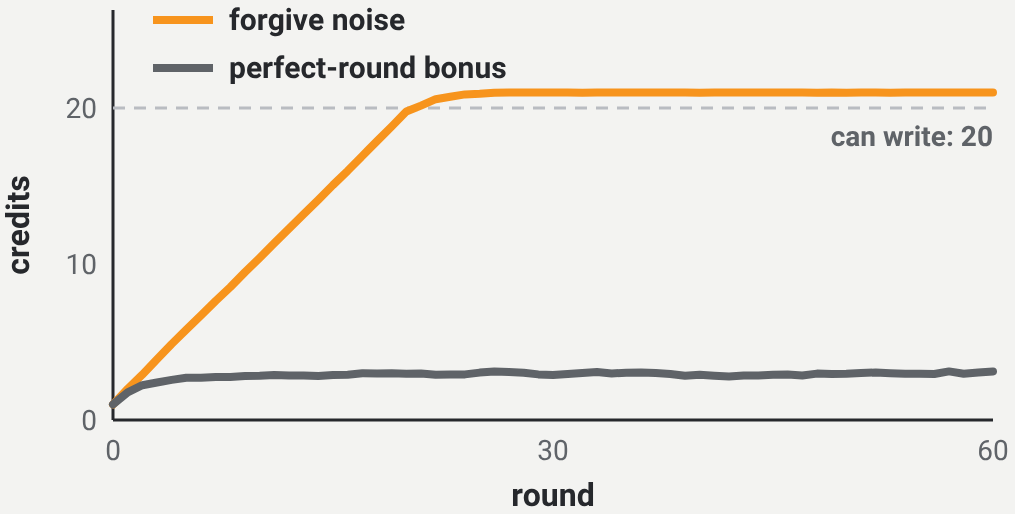
Reviewers err, say, 1 time in 5: the more you send, the rarer a perfect round





The fix: forgive what noise explains

Only rejections beyond what noise plausibly causes cost a credit



- **More good papers, more credits**
- **Always at least one**
- **Slow periods: almost free**

Try it

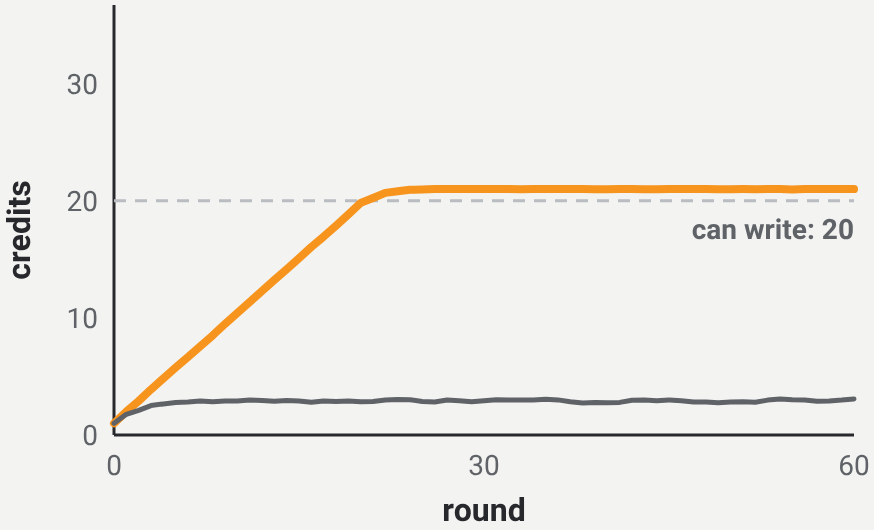
One author, average of 200 runs

Reviewer error **1 in 5** (1 ◀ ▶ 2)

Good papers per round **20** (3 ◀ ▶ 4)

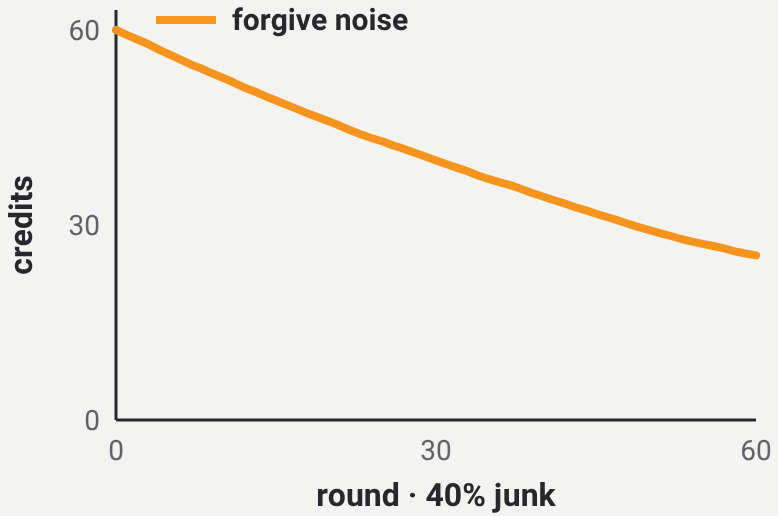
forgive noise

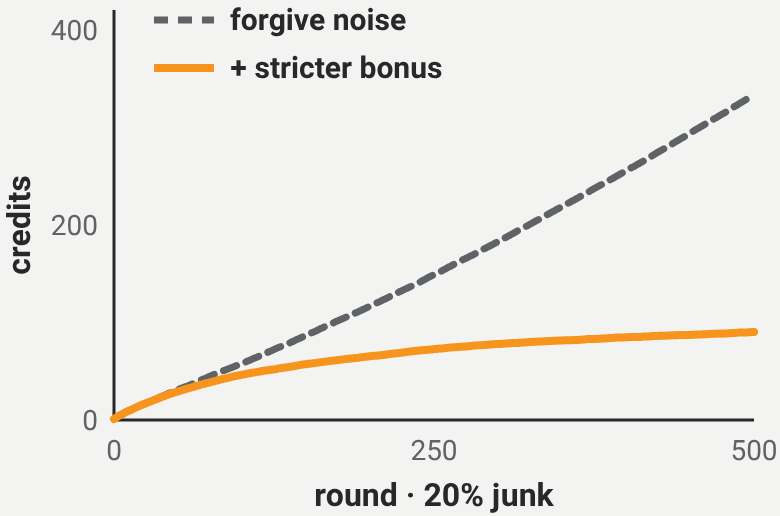
perfect-round bonus



Heavy junk drains; light junk stops growing

For light junk: earning a bonus needs a stricter test than losing a credit





Where this goes

From one venue and one author per paper, toward the real system

Data
real submission records

→

Theory
which wishes fit together

→

Simulation
a sandbox for venues

co-authors share credits

many venues

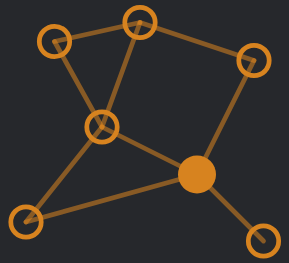
credits for reviewing

beyond science: pull requests · app stores

ISAC Yearly Seminar · Shenkar

Who Gets to Submit?

Designing credit systems for peer review



Nimrod Talmon · with Ariel Rosenfeld, Peter Stone and Staša Milojević

Ben-Gurion University of the Negev · November 2026